Castaspella (A S2 flashback episode)

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Castaspella (A S2 flashback episode)

by es272, Xenakis (IceRosesCrown)

Summary

The tale goes that the villainous Light Spinner used her skills and wit to mould the prodigious Micah into a tool for her ambitions, taking advantage of the boy's heroic nature. Though Castaspella didn't really know, despite the overwhelming presence of the story in her life, she wasn't there to live it.

For all the talk of villains and heroes neither role ever really appealed to Castaspella, both of them so constricting, both so final. Every character is limited by the part they play, so why bother dedicating yourself to one, especially when you can be the one who tells the story, twisting the narrative however you need?

Notes

Hi, hi! Welcome everyone!
This is Xenakis, here to leave a bit of a note for this second one-shot for the Thank You She-Ra event!! :D

In this case, we bring you a Castaspella version of Season 2 Episode 6 *Light Spinner*, were we introduce you to our little… version of Castaspella, by means of flashbacks to her childhood!

So, uh, I hope you enjoy, and this time it also comes with the very first piece of fanart that Es did, which kickstarted this whole series!! I just couldn't help it and Es had this amazing idea, and we began writing it before the event was even a thought XD

Anyways! I hope you enjoy it :3 See you on the end notes!
~Xenakis

See the end of the work for more notes

The night was chilly in Mystacor's beach.

An empty sky with nothing but the Moons hanging up there extended over her…

It helped the young Castaspella clear her mind as she laid on her back.

She specially needed it that night; it had barely been a week since she got the letter from Bright Moon.

Her brother was gone…

She was fairly safe…

…But the loss and all that followed reminded her of her vulnerability, her previous dependence on her brother and his image.

She would have to climb Mystacor's ranks to secure herself a stable position within the kingdom and, maybe, she'd even get to avenge her brother.

So she had to be smart about this.

As she finally sat up, she let out a long sigh.

Looking down at her hands, the glow of magic faintly illuminated her smirk.

Maybe her brother was no longer here for her to rely on, to hide behind, but the chaos of the disbanded Alliance, and the war that raged on despite it all, left behind an unstable kingdom.

She knows that she has to take advantage of this; her heart will always ache with the loss of her brother, but an opportunity like this was fleeting.

So she played with puzzle pieces in her head, trying to arrange her next steps carefully, as she knew that the world of politics was not the one of battle.

Fortunately, Castaspella was patient, *very* patient. And careful.

But it'd take a long time, so she needed to set everything into motion *now*.

The political disarray would allow her to grasp control of Mystacor's inner circles, yet the public was a different story. She never needed to make frequent appearances before, but now it seemed she had no other option.

She needed to *be seen* among the people and yet, at the same time, to keep people's eyes away from her and her schemes. So she would divert their gazes from herself to a perfectly tailored persona: a cheerful, sloppy, and innocent personality, with bursts of emotion and dramatic reactions. Someone no one would suspect, someone hiding in plain sight.

Even better if that managed to keep people at a distance.

She had to take better care of the darkness that shrouded her.

That *protected* her.

Dismissing the magic between her hands, she pushed herself up and returned to her room.

She'd enter Mystacor as a public figure, polishing her act, understanding her surroundings until…

Until?

So focused on keeping herself afloat, she hadn't even thought of what for…

Her mind went blank at the idea of an end goal, not a single thought came and only one image flashed through her mind. The golden halo adorned by that beautiful star.

It carried all of Micah's brightness and Angella's divinity, and her desire for it was so illogical she could laugh. An inanimate object could not make up for what she lacked from others, from *within*; an ornament would not make anyone look at her differently.

Despite it, its image made her feel so pure and seen, at least in her own eyes, and she knew that they were they only ones which would ever spare her a glance.

To prove her worth, even if only to herself…

She would climb her way up to the top... she would become Head Sorceress.

Throughout sleepless nights, Castaspella's memories flowed freely, and she was left carefully observing them.

If she tried hard enough, she could even remember that tutor Micah had…

Though those faded memories were quickly displaced by more recent ones.

She recalled how proud she had always been of her brother.

She wanted to be like him; she couldn't wait for her sorcery classes to begin. She'd work hard and practice until she was as good as him.

However, she wasn't prepared for *not* being an immediate success as a pupil.

She'd never forget the disappointment in her masters' voices when they realized Castaspella wasn't the prodigy Micah was. He was so much older… By the time she began her classes everyone had long forgotten his beginnings and failures. Being compared to her already-trained brother, she was practically set up for failure.

But that wouldn't stop her from reaching for the same level of skill, of course.

At first, she wanted to impress everyone the same way he did. She saw his bright and flashy illusions, the way he could manipulate elements with little to no effort.

Oh, but people's captivated gazes and words full of admiration seemed warmer than any fire Micah could summon, and she craved so desperately to feel just a touch of that warmth.

She was determined…

Then, one day, she finally managed to summon fireworks… and set half a garden on fire.

Immediately, Micah was there, waving his hands to summon perfectly controlled clouds that rained all over the garden, putting out the flames.

He came out of nowhere to save the day. A dozen acolytes surrounded him and gushed over his mastery of sorcery. The Head Sorcerer showed up personally to congratulate and thank him.

They were all so focused on *him*… that they didn't even wonder who started the fire to begin with.

Castaspella was still on her knees, looking at the charred grass, even after they all left.

She noticed the burns on her hands, and yet she had never before felt so cold. In the absence of emotion, her mind fell into deep thought.

That wasn't the first time it happened, but it was when she *finally* realized a few things: She would never be like Micah, she would never be noticed or recognized regardless of what she did, and she did *not* need any of that…

Her brother cast a massive shadow over Castaspella, which she had tried to dismiss for a long time.

She tried to get out of it and shine on her own. She tried to get rid of it by summoning her own light.

But now she understood: she had to embrace that shadow, explore its limits, and take advantage of it.

So she started slow with a few tests: incidents similar to that of the garden, but not accidental anymore.

No consequences for her.

Hence, she moved onto something *else*.

Complex spells, *dangerous* spells, capable of dealing swiftly with anything if done right…

But quite deadly if done wrong.

And it took Castaspella many years to master them.

Even so, no matter how many times she failed, no matter how many things broke, how many people got hurt… did anyone ever turn to look at her as the culprit?

No.

As soon as Micah showed up to save the day, heal the wounded, and put out the fire, no one cared about anything other than how wonderfully skilled he was…

With time, it had allowed her to experiment even further; she kept pushing limits with *everyone*.

Castaspella smirked thinking about it… She felt like she was punishing them all – denying them the truth the same way they had deprived her of their hope and expectation.

In her world there was love: her brother loved her. He had always said that she was the first great thing that had ever happened to him, first out of three; a little sister who looked up at him with wide eyes so full of awe. Sometimes she felt like his love for that little girl was so deep it smothered everything else about her beyond that point.

A disturbingly complex book was just harmless entertainment in his eyes, a coat of blood, just a beautiful red dress – after all, his sister could do nothing but innocently adore him with her clasped hands; no good, no wrong.

The rest were different; they did not love her, they did not hate her. Only sometimes, upon a wrong turn of the head they'd look at her, looked down on her through the blurry lens of her brother's achievements, scoffed, and then turned a blind eye.

Indifference. Only love and indifference existed in her world, and both were entirely devoid of any acknowledgement or recognition.

So, if they loved her, she lived as she did, and if they were indifferent, she *punished them*, turned her face from them before they could do the same. Before, they didn't care for her, and now, she *wants them* not to care; they're falling for an act, *they're the ones in the dark*, really…

Castaspella let out a long sigh.

It was always the same when she couldn't sleep.

Looking back at all the memories, her mind always seemed to run back to the same place. She wished she could beat it out of herself, but it's difficult to fight what gives you the strength to raise your hand in the first place.

She had chosen to use it, weaponize the ridicule, and protect the shadows that fell on her.

Now she no longer needed to hide behind her brother… she could cast the shadow on her own and hide behind it.

The crown on her head gave her the stability she had once sought, though it never truly anchored.

Then that sudden attack from the Horde's dark sorceress shook all the fears in the back of her mind loose.

If Adora hadn't appeared when she did, Castaspella would have had to take it upon herself to handle the situation.

But waiting… waiting and observing was always a wiser move.

She trusted her niece, she knew there was a reason why Glimmer spoke so highly of Adora.

Of She-Ra.

Openly powerful and skilled people were always a good cover for Castaspella, weren't they?

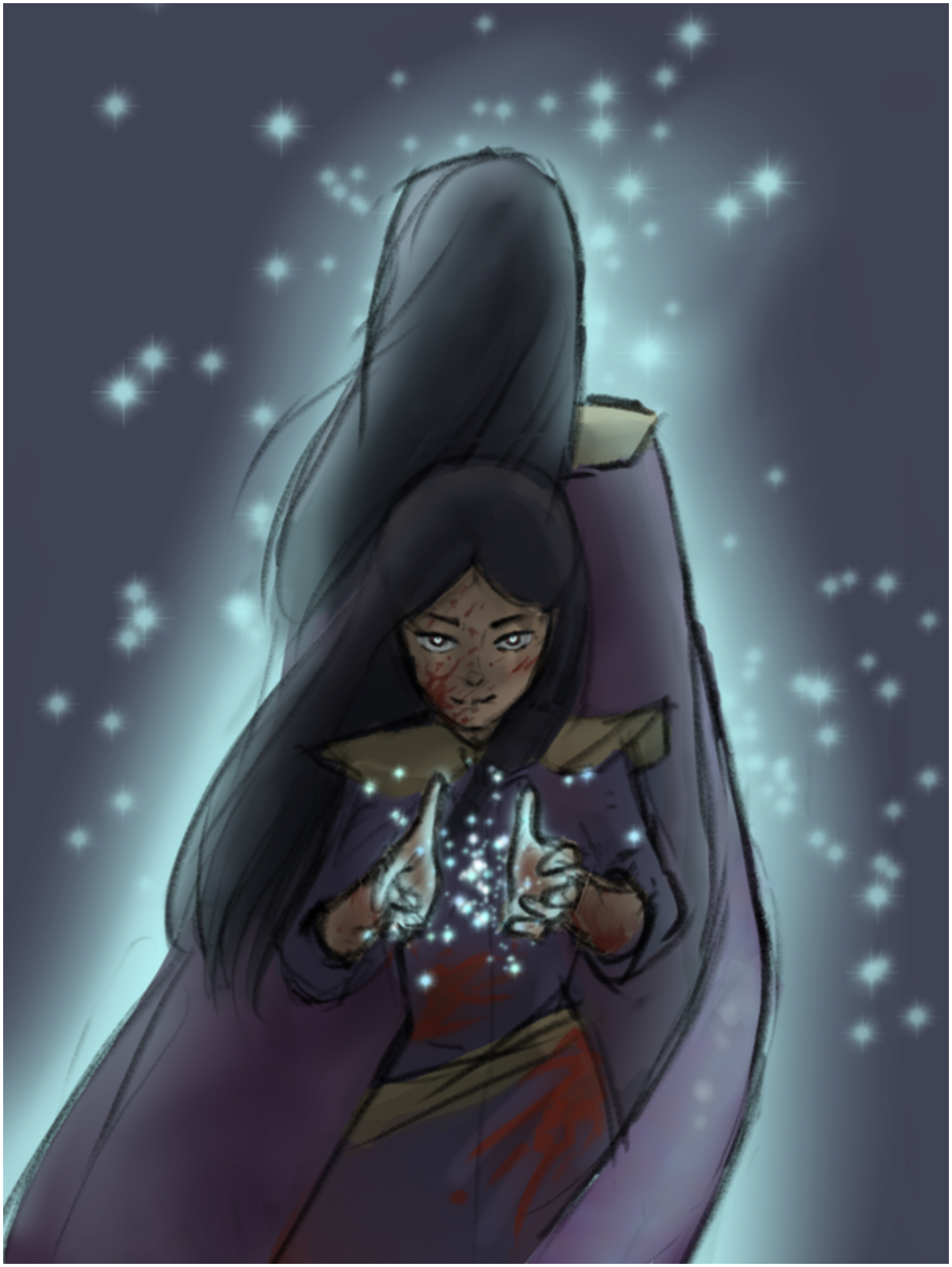
In any case, that night was the alignment once again. It was her duty to reinforce the shield protecting Mystacor, and with any luck, there would be no surprise attacks from that Shadow Weaver this time.

Castaspella wasn't sure she'd ever want to face her again; morbid curiosity could be her ruin, after all.

She combed her hair in place as the moons outside moved closer and closer to each other. She looked at them as her hands ran down her body to straighten her already perfectly ironed clothes.

Going over their previous encounter on her way to the Lunarium, she was truly unaware of just how soon she'd be seeing the dark sorceress again, albeit under much different circumstances.

End Notes



Art by Es272

I hope u enjoyed and see you next week with another one-shot of this same series :D
~Xenakis

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!